

THE PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

Study this text:

The Boatswain **has received** a number of orders because of the storm.
 As soon as the Third Officer **has come** from his watch he goes to inspect the Boatswain's work.

- "Have you **checked** all lashings on deck and doubled them?" he asks.
- "No, I **haven't**, not yet, sir," answers the Boatswain.
- "Have you **secured** all hatch covers?"
- "Yes, I have indeed, sir. The deckhands **have cleared away** all loose gear from the deck. **They have also tightened** all the life boat gripes. Finally they **have made sure** that all the cranes are secure", answers the Boatswain.

The Boatswain **has done** a thorough job as always.

The **Perfect Tense** expresses what someone has done or what has happened. It **tells us about a period of time from the past until now. The result is still relevant now.**

The Present Perfect is formed with the auxiliary **have/ has + past participle of the main verb**. The past participle has the **ending -ed** for regular verbs and is **the third form** in the **list of irregular verbs**.

Examples:

I have **written down** the message.

A vessel **has entered** the fairway at Mouro Lighthouse.

I / we / you / they

have

he, she

has

**sailed
finished
lost
written
been**

etc.